

Who we are - Our Program

The Independence/Democracy Group in the European Parliament was set up on 20 July 2004. It incorporates EU-critics, eurosceptics and eurorealists. The main goals of the Group are to reject the Treaty establishing a constitution for Europe and to oppose all forms of centralisation. Some members within the group, notably the United Kingdom Independence Party (UKIP), advocate the complete withdrawal of their country from the EU.

Among the aims of the Group there is also the promotion of democracy. In fact, being the only Group in the European Parliament that opposes the European constitution, IND/DEM is giving voice to millions of people that wouldn't be otherwise represented.

Transparency is another important point of the Group's agenda.

The IND/DEM Group comprises of 22 Members coming from 9 different countries, as follows: Czech Republic (1), Denmark (1), Greece (1) , France (3), Ireland (1), The Netherlands (2), Sweden (2), UK (8), Poland (3). The Group's leaders are Nigel Farage (UKIP) and Kathy Sinnott (Independent, Ireland) .

The Group is open to Members that subscribe to a Europe of Sovereign Nation States and acknowledge the United Nations Declaration on Human Rights and parliamentary democracy.

IND/DEM subscribes to the following political programme:

1. Rejection of the European Constitution

Convinced that the legitimate level for democracy lies with the nation states and their parliaments since there is no such thing as a single European people. The Ind/Dem Group opposes any European Constitution, as it would exacerbate the present undemocratic and centralist political structure of the EU. The Ind/Dem Group demands that the proposed Constitution be submitted to the peoples' vote through free and fair national referenda in the member states.

2. No to a European superstate

Favouring an open, transparent, democratic and accountable co-operation between sovereign European states, the Ind/Dem Group strongly rejects the creation of a single European superstate.

3. Respect for traditional and cultural values

Peoples and nations have the right to define and protect their own traditional, ethical and cultural values. The Ind/Dem Group rejects xenophobia, antisemitism and any other form of discrimination.

4. Democracy, freedom and co-operation between sovereign states

Committed to the principles of democracy, freedom and co-operation between nation states, the Ind/Dem Group rejects the centralisation and bureaucratisation of Europe.

5. Respect for national differences and interests: Freedom of votes

Agreeing on embodying these principles in its proceedings, the IND/DEM Group respects the freedom of its delegations to vote as they see fit.